

TEACHING STATEMENT

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How I Teach

I believe students learn computing by writing code, making mistakes, and fixing them. I do not want them only to watch slides or memorise syntax. I want them to understand a problem, try a solution, and learn from the result. My role is to make this process clear and manageable.

Before my PhD, I worked for four years as a software engineer. This experience still shapes my teaching. Real systems are rarely neat, and code does not always work on the first try. I therefore focus on working code, debugging, and the practical reason behind each concept.

In the Classroom

At Hamad Bin Khalifa University, I taught Principles of Computing to undergraduate students and Information Management Systems to graduate students. Their experience levels were very different. Some students were new to programming, while others already had strong skills. I usually start with a simple example. I then explain the main idea and ask students to use it in a new problem.

I often use live coding. I do not hide every mistake. When the code fails, I show students how I read the error, test an idea, and try again. I also use short exercises during class. Their answers help me decide when to slow down or explain the topic in another way.

Supporting Students

Students should feel comfortable asking questions. I treat errors as part of learning, not as failure. I have studied and worked in multilingual settings, and I learned computing in a second language. I understand that some students need more time to follow a technical explanation. I provide written notes, check understanding, and use more than one example when needed.

Mentoring and Future Teaching

I have mentored MSc students and junior researchers. I help them choose a clear research question, design experiments, examine results honestly, and write their work. At the start, I give close guidance. Later, I step back so they can make their own decisions.

I can teach programming in Python and Java, data structures, databases, software engineering, machine learning, natural language processing, and applied AI. I would also like to develop courses on multimodal AI and large language model evaluation. My main goal is simple: students should leave my course with the confidence to learn the next topic by themselves.